



[Weekly Market Commentary](#)

Dear clients,

- **The total altcoin market cap has approximately doubled since April 2025.** However, crypto markets experienced whiplash this week as the ebullient altcoin rally (heralding the potential start of an “alt season”) was challenged by some sharp corrections. Developments remain fluid.
- **Elevated altcoin open interest dominance foreshadowed this week's altcoin de-leveraging event.** The Altcoin Open-Interest Dominance Ratio, which measures altcoin contract value against BTC derivative open interest, signaled concentrated leverage. A sustained pullback in the ratio could suggest orderly de-risking and a healthier altcoin advance, while continued elevation may indicate further shake-outs and altcoin valuation pressure.
- **NFT trading volumes staged their first meaningful rebound since January,** but the total NFT market cap is still well under late 2024 levels. NFT trading participation remains narrow, with volume concentrated among a few high-value addresses.
- **A long exit queue for Ethereum staking has raised concerns about ETH supply dynamics and price momentum.** While some of the demand to unstake stems from profit-taking, a DeFi liquidity crunch has also forced many leveraged traders to unstake their liquid staking tokens recently to repay underlying loans, extending the exit queue.
- **Polymarket acquired QCEX,** a CFTC-licensed exchange and clearinghouse, paving its way to re-enter the US market. Separately, Polymarket says it is considering whether to launch a proprietary stablecoin to capture yield on its betting pool balances.
- **Meanwhile, we’ve got a busy upcoming week for macro.** There’s the Fed meeting on July 30, the lifting of US reciprocal tariffs on August 1 (August 12 for China), and the impact of upcoming Q2 earnings reports from major tech companies – all as we approach the month-end rebalancing period for many institutional investors.
- Finally, in our latest [Monthly Outlook: The Great Ethereum vs Solana Debate](#), we take a longer-term view on institutional interest as it expands from BTC to altcoins like ETH and SOL, even though the near-term price action will likely be driven more by technical factors than fundamentals.

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Best,
The Coinbase Institutional Team

Weekly Market Call

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